

A.1

The problem for taking care of the turtles in TU are the turtles behavior and size between each other and themselves. Whether that would be the problems with insufficient environmental space between themselves, or the lack of behavioral stimulation. The caretakers also have trouble maintaining the health of the turtles, notably the overall efficiency of their procedures.

A.2/3

The turtle's size proves to be a notable issue with space management. With one turtle being significantly bigger than the other, the usage of the basking area is unsuitable for both turtles to occupy at once. Separating them, providing space for both will cause depression due to their history of being together since birth. For the smaller turtle, reaching the basking area proves to be difficult due to an injury from aggression in the past, therefore causing difficulty walking up the plank to the basking area.

Though physical health can be easily spotted due to the overall shape of their shells, their emotions are difficult to determine. Other than each other, there is nothing for exercise, with the turtles becoming notably overweight, it causes less impact than if they were underweight. The big turtle has a tendency to eat everything, including an attempt to consume inedible décor, providing a challenge to create and equipment that is durable.

The caretakers often handle the cleanliness and monitoring of the turtles, but their methods are far from efficient. They often note the tedious task of cleaning the tanks, using a siphon of a tube that stretches from the tank to a sink of RO water from a different room. Draining water is also a tedious task, and they have thought of a solution of adding a hole in the bottom of the tank to drain water more efficiently. Whenever they do have to remove the turtles based on procedures such as tank cleaning, or possible sickness with one turtle, puts them at risk of being harmed.

A.4/5/6

The solution would overall improve the turtles quality of life, and the caretakers efficiency executing procedures. In the attempt to solve this issue, the safety of all parties need to be considered. The current caretakers would need to find the solution easy to use and effective from their old solution, while the turtle would need to be safe. In violation of either the safety and wellness of the caretakers and turtles, Jorge Gomez-Jurado would be at risk with IACUC.